

Medford Public Schools
Medford, Massachusetts

Medford School Committee
Committee of the Whole
September 29, 2014

Minutes

The Medford School Committee of the Whole was called to order at 7:00 p.m. in the Superintendent's Conference Room at Medford High School by Vice Chairperson John Falco Jr.

All rose to Salute the Flag.

The following members were present: Ann Marie Cugno, Erin DiBenedetto, John Falco Jr, George Scarpelli, Robert E. Skerry Jr. and Paulette Van der Kloot (present, 1 absent) Also present: Superintendent Roy Belson, Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson, Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell, Director of Humanities Nicole Chiesa, Director of Mathematics and Science Carolyn Joy, Coordinator of Science Rocco Cieri, Director of Pupil Services Kathleen Medaglio, Coordinator of ELL Leslie Trotta and all principals.

Chairperson Falco stated the purpose of the meeting was to discuss the 2014 MCAS results.

Superintendent Belson provided an overview of the MCAS program and indicated that the ranking methodology needed deeper interpretation. Students on the "cusp" must be factored into our understanding because it provides us with an analysis of proximity to proficiency. We also need to look at the specific areas of achievement and non-achievement to determine what deserves greater instructional emphasis.

Director of Humanities Nicole Chiesa reviewed her detailed report on ELA performance. (see attached grade span highlights)

Director of Mathematics Carolyn John reviewed her detailed report on mathematics performance (see attached grade span highlights).

Coordinator of Science Rocco Cieri reviewed his detailed report on science performance.(see attached grade span highlights)

Director of Curriculum Bernadette Ricciardelli discussed the performance of subgroups and provided comparisons. (see attached information) She provided the following information:

- The percentage of students scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient performance levels in ELA at Medford High School is the same percentage at the

following schools: Andover High School, Natick High School, Needham High School, North Reading High School, and Newburyport High School; and is higher than the following schools: North Andover High School, Saugus High School, Swampscott High School, Watertown High School, Wakefield High School.

- The percentage of students scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient performance levels in mathematics at MHS is higher than the percentage students scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient levels at Rockport High School, Saugus High School, Reading High School Malden High School and Ipswich High School.
- The percentage of students at MHS and MVTHS scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient performance levels is higher than the percentage of students scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient levels at Melrose High School, Andover High School, Bedford High School and Winchester High School.
- The percentage of grade 5 students scoring Advanced in science at the Brooks School is higher than students scoring Advanced at the Horace Mann School in Melrose, the Penn Brook Elementary School in Georgetown, and the Proctor Elementary School in Topsfield.
- The percentage of grade 5 students scoring in the combined Advanced and Proficient performance levels in science at the Brooks School is higher than students scoring a combined Advanced and Proficient score at the Joshua Eaton School in Reading, Mystic Valley Charter School in Malden, and the Atkinson Elementary School in North Andover.

Deputy Superintendent Beverly Nelson discussed Medford's accountability status and drew comparisons between the State and Medford performances. (see attached information). Medford High School and Medford Vocational are Level I schools and our elementary and middle schools are Level 2 schools. The overall rating is Level 2. This year school systems such as Winchester, Brookline, Bedford and Andover are also Level 2. For an urban rim district Level 2 is a very solid rating.

The State (see chart) average ratings using the CPI index are below Medford in most subgroups. We are eight points higher than the State for the aggregate of high needs students.

Assistant Superintendent Diane Caldwell discussed the elementary school results. This is the first year for using our new literacy series Journey and we are introducing a new math series (EnVision) during SY 2014-15. It takes time for these new initiatives to produce results.

ELL Coordinator Leslie Trotta reviewed ELL MCAS performance. Medford outperformed the State by three points overall. Medford also did well on the AMAO report.

Key discussion points:

- We need to ensure a full implementation of our new ELA and math programs to increase performance. Interventions should address the data analysis on a school and subgroup specific basis.
- “Cusp” analysis is an important way to zero in on specific issues to see if one or two more answers would produce higher proficiency.
- Our growth scores were in the high average range. This is an important indicator as a measure of improvement.
- Cohort tracking is another key way to view progress. Medford scores get stronger as we move up the grades.
- More work needs to be done on open response questions grades 3-8.
- Greater emphasis on the use of data is essential. All teachers must be data informed. We will be providing guidance on this issue. We must set-up formal data teams.

The Administration will continue to review results and work with the faculty to promote improvement. Additional reports will be forthcoming as we progress throughout the year.

On the motion of Ms. Van der Kloot, seconded by Ms. Cugno, the meeting was adjourned at 9:57 p.m.

Respectfully submitted,

John Falco Jr.
Vice Chairperson